

A spider traps a damselfly, demonstrating that the principle of food size can be modified by the comparative aggression and strength of the predator and its prey.

Ecological niches

An animal or plant’s niche is its ecological role or way of life. For American zoologist Joseph Grinnell, working in the early decades of the 20th century, an organism’s niche was defined as its habitat. He studied birds called thrashers in California and observed how they fed, nested, and